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EE/RPF

For use from May/November 2027

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Student personal code:

Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

Student: *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.

Supervisor: *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.

First reflection session

Month: February DP year (1 or 2): 1 Supervisor initials: MH

Interim reflection session

Month: November DP year (1 or 2): 2 Supervisor initials: MH

Final reflection session – Viva voce

Month: February DP year (1 or 2): 2 Supervisor initials: MH

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Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

Through the initial session, I realised the importance of making my RQ formulated and argumentative, amending it such that it would be more focused on "why" stage effects are used, instead of "how". Doing so will hopefully allow me to look at Frankenstein critically, while also furthering my analysis by enabling me to analyse the different stage effects objectively. I managed to find a wide range of sources such as reviews, interviews from cast/crew, and even academic journals that allowed me to understand the director's intentions was to bring out themes of innocence and cruelty/kindness, as well as how lighting, set, and sound were used to amplify and support these themes.

The amount of my research ended up being quite messy and thus, when writing my draft I made a mindmap for everything I had done so far, and a timeline to plan out my next steps in order to combat this.

I believe the draft encouraged me to view a play from a researcher's perspective, teaching me to view a play subjectively and analytically. However, my draft wasn't without fault. I realised that I was too focused on basing my research on different methods of lighting that I have neglected to research how an audience would perceive said methods. I decided to make steps towards defining "audience perception" and analysing how lighting choices affected established definitions of audience perception rather than using my own. I also realised that it was important to focus my analysis on the play Frankenstein and to ensure my analysis is in reference to specific moments within, so the essay is organised and coherent. Through my supervisor's comments, I saw mistakes within my citation format as well as the reliability of some sources that I had to double check clearly or else risk a reader not knowing where my information was cited from or whether it was reliable.

After reading my essay again, I believe that I could have attempted to word my research question differently or find a different method to which I could measure "audience perception" instead of just relying on reviews as proof. I've come to realise how everyone might perceive lighting differently on stage and thus believe that by making said changes, I could have allowed the essay to be more critical in opening a debate about how certain lighting effects could have different meanings, or how lighting was used such that it could work however it was interpreted. However, although I have been unable to write the perfect essay especially when it comes to making implications and looking at things critically, I have still improved upon my first draft in which I have finally been able to balance out lighting knowledge with examples of them affecting the audience. I am also proud of this essay in how I have been able to gain knowledge on lighting from scratch, such that no matter how it turns out I can still call my essay an accomplished piece of work for me.

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